# Tran Le

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## Education

**Cornell University** **Ithaca, NY**
*B.A. Information Science (Honors) & Psychology (Honors)* 2023–2027
*Concentrations: Behavioral Science, User Experience, Cognition*

- **Cumulative GPA:** 4.223/4.3
- **Advisors:** Dr. Susan Fussell (Information Science), Dr. Charles Brainerd (Psychology)

## Honors & Awards

**CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher Award (Cornell Nominee)** 2026
Selected as one of 2-4 undergraduates nominated by Cornell Information Science for the national round.

**Cornell Summer Experience Grant ($3,500)** 2026
Awarded for the research internship at the Gopnik Cognitive Development and Learning Lab, UC Berkeley.

**Cornell Psychology Summer Undergraduate Research Funding (SURF) ($1,320)** 2026
Awarded to support an independent Psychology honors thesis.

**Tapia Conference on Technology and Computing Travel Award ($1,500)** 2026
Selected as 1 of 2 undergraduate award recipients funded by Cornell's Department of Information Science.

**Phi Beta Kappa (Vice President)** 2026
Elected as a junior; top 3% of Cornell College of Arts and Sciences class.

**Cornell Combined Scholarship Package ($98,529 annually)** 2023–present
Awarded Foreign Students Scholarship, Sugita Family Scholarship, and S. H. Baik Family Scholarship.

## Papers & Posters

[P1] **"Who's Doing the Reviewing? Tracing AI Delegation in Scientific Peer Review"** [link]
**Tran Le**, Eunice Yiu
*Accepted at AI-Native Academia and AI & Science - Evolution or Extinction? @ NeurIPS 2026*
*Submitted to CHI 2027*

[P2] **"Semantic Attribute Perception in Large Language Models"** [link]
Ben Chen, Isabella Cranshaw, **Tran Le**, Olivia Qin, Bianca Thompson, Owen Yan, Xinya Liu, Charles J. Brainerd
*Presented at Cornell Undergraduate Psychology Conference 2026*

## Research Experience

**Cognitive Development and Learning Lab (PI: Professor Alison Gopnik)** **Berkeley, CA**
*Research Assistant, Summer Research Intern* Jun–Sep 2026
*(Selected as 1 of 7 students from 400+ applicants)*

**1. Independent Project: Who's Doing the Reviewing? Tracing AI Delegation in Scientific Peer Review [P1]**

- Recruited 100+ researchers to study how they consult and incorporate AI assistance while reading papers and forming scientific peer-review judgments.
- Built a Node/Express study platform with Google Cloud Storage/Firestore and backend API calls via the OpenAI API to trace source-paper engagement, AI consultation, review construction, and evidence localization.
- Coded AI query functions, classified AI-use groups, and analyzed normalized Levenshtein distance of post-paste editing, lexical Jaccard similarity, semantic cosine similarity, and inability to locate source-paper evidence in R.
- Trained two undergraduate coders to evaluate perspective similarity through pairwise idea-level comparisons and evidence grounding through ratings of evidentiary support and selection precision.

**2. When Do Children Delegate Inquiry to AI? Measuring Developmental Reliance**

- Examined (1) children's help-seeking preferences across informational, emotional, and social contexts, and (2) their allocation of causal inquiry among self-exploration, AI-provided evidence, and AI-provided solutions.
- Administered 23 testing sessions with children aged 6–12 in person at museums and remotely through Children Helping Science using a blicket-machine causal-learning paradigm.

**Memory and Neuroscience Lab (PI: Professor Charles Brainerd)** **Ithaca, NY**
*Honors Student, Research Assistant* Aug 2025–present

**1. Honors Thesis: Cognitive Offloading and Deep Distortions in Episodic and Semantic Memory**

- Investigate whether cognitive offloading amplifies deep memory distortions – patterns of judgments about the same item or event that collectively violate logical or probabilistic principles – across memory systems.
- Develop episodic- and semantic-memory experiments using the Deese–Roediger–McDermott (DRM) and Distortions in Everyday Memory (DEM) paradigms with offloading manipulations and conjoint recognition.
- Build custom Qualtrics interfaces that simulate two offloading contexts: external storage through saved word lists and retrieval/verification support through a Google Programmable Search Engine.
- Develop an analysis plan using multinomial processing tree models to estimate verbatim, gist, and response bias parameters from true/false recognition and test offloading effects via equality constrained model comparisons.

**2. General Lab Projects**

- Collect semantic attribute ratings for 2,000+ items across multiple LLMs [P2] and clean data from an episodic-memory study of probability violations in recognition and source-memory judgments.
- Implement Qualtrics surveys and proctor 45 false-recognition reversal, memory-framing, paired-similarity, eyewitness deep-distortion, and false-memory experiments.

**Communication and Collaborative Technologies Lab (PI: Professor Susan Fussell)** **Ithaca, NY**
*Honors Student, Research Assistant* Feb 2025–present

**1. Independent Project: Language of Interaction in AI-Assisted Ideation**

- Lead a 6-person undergraduate and master's research team to investigate how multilingual, non-native English-speaking students use generative AI for ideation across their native language (L1) and English.
- Design a counterbalanced within-subject study comparing L1 and English chatbot-assisted brainstorming and outlining, with counterbalanced language order and problem-solution writing prompts.
- Deploy a custom platform with a self-hosted Gemma-powered multilingual chatbot via Ollama, an outline editor, Node/Express backend, SQLite interaction logging, and post-task ratings and language-profile questionnaires.
- Analyze perceived experience across cognitive, evaluative, prompting, and agency dimensions and the extent of its alignment with students' usual AI language and usual preferred languages for thinking processes in R.

**2. XPLAIN: Proactivity in Scaffolding Comprehension and Production in Real-Time Turn-Taking**

- Develop XPLAIN, a video-conferencing AI assistant that supports shared grounding through proactive, real-time content prediction and generation tailored to users' languages, domain knowledge, and communication needs.
- Design conversational scenarios; clarifications, suggestions, summaries, language-switching features; Figma flows; bilingual-history and domain-familiarity surveys; and native-language, English, and bilingual support formats.
- Manage scheduling; administer 27 user study sessions; code disfluency, gaze, and interaction data from 38 video recordings; thematically analyze interview transcripts in ATLAS.ti; analyze survey and behavioral data in R.
- Compare AI disfluency labels with ground truth; calculate inter-rater reliability; author coding schemes and audit guides defining acoustic, timing, semantic, and syntactic boundary rules across disfluency categories.

***NSF I-Corps Regional Course***

- Accepted into a 3-week intensive program applying business model canvas, value proposition testing, customer archetypes, and pivoting frameworks to explore and improve XPLAIN's real-world applications.
- Conduct 30 interviews with patients, doctors, therapists, insurance staff, and refugee-services staff to refine XPLAIN's customer segment, beachhead use case, and adoption barriers around insurance and care navigation.

**Research Project with Professor Allison Koenecke & Dr. Anaïs Rameau** **Ithaca, NY**
*Research Assistant* Jul 2025–May 2026

- Transcribed ∼1,000 dysphonic speech recordings in Praat to produce ground-truth data for evaluating the performance of commercial automated speech recognition (ASR) systems on medically impaired speech.
- Collaborated with Weill Cornell Medicine and adhered to HIPAA-compliant data management workflows.

**Cornell Phonetics Lab (PI: Professor Samuel Tilsen)** **Ithaca, NY**
*Research Assistant* Aug–Dec 2024

- Studied how random, constrained interactions shape the emergence of dialects across networks of speakers.
- Reviewed Whisper-generated transcripts, created ground-truth Praat TextGrid files, and parsed, analyzed, and visualized TextGrid annotations in R to examine phonetic, lexical, and conversational trends and patterns.

**Research Project with Professor Shimon Edelman** **Ithaca, NY**
*Research Assistant* Dec 2023–Dec 2024

- Examined turn-taking timing variations in bilingual, autistic, Down syndrome, and typically developing children through conversational factors such as pause length, utterance initiation speed, and conversational flow.
- Annotated 133 naturalistic caregiver-child conversations (children aged 15–25 months) in ELAN, coding speech onsets and offsets for turn-transition latency analyses and calculating reliability with ICC and Cohen's kappa.
- Conducted literature reviews on turn-taking, attention, pragmatics, joint engagement, and computational frameworks, and trained 3 new lab members on coding protocols and literature review workflows.

## Hackathons

**CMD-IT Tapia GenAI Student Hackathon** **Atlanta, GA**
*Winner ($100)* Sep 2026

- Designed a multi-agent fact-checker that extracts and classifies factual claims from online essays, verifies claims against outside sources, and generates reports annotated with claim-level verdicts and confidence scores.
- Used Python, OpenRouter, OpenAI SDK, Claude Sonnet, Qwen2.5 via Ollama, BeautifulSoup, and Dux Distributed Global Search.

## Internship Experience

**Clinical Psychology Unit (University Medical Center HCMC)** **Vietnam**
*Intern* Jun–July 2024

- Shadowed 65 psychiatrist-led counseling sessions for patients with neurodevelopmental, anxiety, depressive, and trauma-related disorders, observing cognitive behavioral, dialectical behavior, and relaxation therapies.
- Wrote case reports summarizing patient histories and practicing multimodal therapy (BASIC I.D.) case conceptualization, DSM-V diagnostic reasoning, and intervention planning under psychiatrist mentorship.

## Teaching Experience

**INFO 4505: Computing and Global Development** **Ithaca, NY**
*Teaching Assistant* Aug 2026–present

- Mentor 5 project teams applying Information and Communication Technologies and Development (ICTD) and human-centered design frameworks to underserved-community projects.
- Design AI-resistant assignments, create reading quizzes, hold office hours, support Canvas/Slack communication, and grade activities, project presentations, milestones, and deliverables for 130+ students.

**INFO 2310: Interactive Web Application Design and Development** **Ithaca, NY**
*Teaching Assistant* Jan–May 2026

- Graded assignments and exams and led weekly practice problem workshops for 40+ students on JavaScript, React, client-server architecture, REST APIs, MongoDB, Express, and HTTP communication.

**INFO 1300: Introductory Design and Programming for the Web** **Ithaca, NY**
*Teaching Assistant* Aug–Dec 2025

- Supported 50+ students in learning HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and user-centered design by proctoring weekly quizzes, reviewing solutions, holding weekly office hours, and grading assignments.

**CS 1110: Introduction to Computing: A Design and Development Perspective** **Ithaca, NY**
*Course Consultant* Jan–May 2025

- Supported 40+ students through biweekly lab sections, weekly consulting hours, debugging help, exam preparation, and detailed grading feedback on Python assignments and exams.

## Activities

**Women in Computing at Cornell (WICC)** **Ithaca, NY**
*Faculty Relations Director* Jan–Dec 2025

- Organized the Lunch Bunch program, facilitating weekly roundtable discussions that connected 70+ underclasswomen with computing faculty and promoted research opportunities.
- Represented WICC and the computing student body at semesterly faculty board meetings, synthesizing feedback from 200+ students on coursework, workload, advising, and office hours to inform departmental improvements.

**Cornell's Translator Interpreter Program (TIP)** **Ithaca, NY**
*Volunteer* Dec 2024–May 2026

- Translated and interpreted for organizations serving immigrants with limited English proficiency.
- Reviewed and corrected workplace performance document translations, provided live interpretation during parent meetings, and translated institutional materials (e.g., employee health benefits).

**Cornell Undergraduate Research Board (CURB)** **Ithaca, NY**
*Peer Mentor* Oct–Dec 2024

- Led weekly group discussions and one-on-one check-ins to advise 7 students on professor outreach, lab selection, application strategies, and basic research skills.

**Professional Membership:** Information Science Student Association (Member) | Psi Chi (Member)

## Skills & Tools

- **Programming & Data Analysis:** R, Python, JavaScript, SQL
- **Web & Application Development:** React, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, Git, HTML, CSS
- **Research & Design:** Figma, Qualtrics, Google Cloud Storage/Firestore, SONA, ATLAS.ti, Praat, ELAN
- **Documentation & Presentation:** LaTeX, R Markdown, Canva, Microsoft Office, Google Suites
- **UX & User Research:** Contextual Interviews, Customer Discovery, Stakeholder Mapping, User Archetypes, Affinity Diagramming, Competitive Analysis, Scenario Mapping, Storyboard Sketching, Design Systems, Interaction Design, Visual Design, Prototyping, Heuristic Evaluations, Usability Testing
- **Language:** English (proficient), Vietnamese (native)